MEDIEVAL HISTORY

14. Who among the following introduced the famous Persian Festival of NAWROJ in India?
(a) Balban (b) Iltutmish
(c) Firoz Tughlaq (d) Alauddin Khilji

Ans. (a) : The festival of Navroz or Jamshed-i-Navroz/Jamshed-i-Nouroz is named after the Persian king, Jamshed, who is credited for creating the Persian or the Shahenshahi calendar. As per the legend, Jamshed saved the world from an apocalypse that came in the form of a winter and destined to kill everyone.
In India Balban introduced the famous Persian festival of Navroj in order to impress nobles and the rich people. In India, the Parsi community, predominant in Mumbai and Gujarat who follow Zoroastrianism, celebrate Navroz or the Parsi New Year.

15. Assertion (A): Babur wrote his memoirs Baburnama in Turki.
Reason (R): Turki was the official language of the Mughal Court.
In the context of the above two statements which one of the following is correct?
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

Ans. (c) : Babur wrote his autobiography named Baburnama. Baburnama was written in Turkish language and hence, assertion A is correct. Abdur Rahim khanakhana translated Baburnama into Persian language.
The court language of Mughal was Persian not Turkish, so reason mentioned here is incorrect.
Hence, option (c) is correct , A is true and R is false.

16. Which one of the following is a monument constructed by Sher Shah?
(a) Qila-i-Kuhna Mosque at Delhi
(b) Atala Masjid at Jaunpur
(c) Bara Sona Masjid at Gaur
(d) Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque at Delhi

Ans. (a) : Qila-i-Kuhna mosque is part of the Purana Qila fort complex located near the Junna River, north of Humayun's Tomb. Qila-i-Kuhna mosque was built by Sher Shah Suri in 1541 C.E. an Afghan who sent Emperor Humayun into exile between 1538-1555. He also completed building the Purana Qila.
Atala Masjid at Jaunpur was built by Ibrahim Shah Sharqui in1408.
Bara Sona Masjid at Gaur was built by Nusrat Shah, a Bengal province ruler.
Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque at Delhi was built by Qutb-ud-din-Aibak in 1206-1210.

17. In Mughal paintings one notices the adoption of principle of foreshortening whereby near and distant people and things could be placed in perspective. This was due to the influence of the
(a) British (b) Dutch
(c) Portuguese (d) Danish

Ans. (c) : During Jahangir's reign (1605-1627), Mughal Paintings reached its zenith. He took inspiration from his life events and pushed for paintings on those scenarios rather than illustrations on fiction.
Mughal painting emerged from the Persian miniature painting tradition, with additional Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain influences; it usually took the form of book illustrations or single sheets preserved in albums.
The adoption of principle foreshortening whereby near and distant people and things could be placed in perspective. This was due to the influence of the Portuguese.

MODERN HISTORY

18. The Ryotwari Settlement was introduced by the British in the:
(a) Bengal Presidency
(b) Madras Presidency
(c) Bombay Presidency
(d) Madras and Bombay Presidencies

Ans. (d) : Ryotwari System was introduced by Thomas Munro in 1820. In Ryotwari System the ownership rights were handed over to the peasants. British Government collected taxes directly from the peasants. The revenue rates of the Ryotwari System were 50% where the lands were dry and 60% in irrigated land.
It was introduced in madras presidency first then later introduced in regions of Bombay, parts of Assam and Coorg provinces of British India.
The Permanent Settlement was introduced first in Bengal and Bihar and later in the south district of Madras and Varanasi.

19. Uplift of the backward classes was the main programme of the:
(a) Prarthana Samaj (b) Satyashodhak Samaj
(c) Arya Samaj (d) Ramakrishna Mission

Ans. (b) : Satyashodhak Samaj was founded with a purpose to give education to the lower castes. Scheduled caste, scheduled tribes and made them aware of the exploiting tradition of the society. It was founded by Jyotiba Phule in 1873 in Pune. Like every other society this society also imposed a ban on the admission of the high-class people, aristocrats, bureaucracy, and Brahmins. This society only admits in it the members of Shudra Samaj or the people of the lower caste. Upper caste members can only become members of the society by analyzing its actions and habit.

Prarthana Samaj was founded by Atmaram Pandurang in 1867.
Arya Samaj was founded by Swami Dayanand Saraswati in 1875 in Bombay.
Ramkrishna Mission was founded by Swami Vivekanand in 1896 at Belur (Calcutta).

20. The foundation of modern educational system in India was laid by:
(a) The Charter Act of 1813
(b) Macaulay's Minutes of 1835
(c) The Hunter Commission of 1882
(d) Wood's Dispatch of 1854

Ans. (b) : In 1835, the education policy of Lord Macaulay was published titled "Minute on Indian Education" in which he advocated educating Indians through English and also enrich Indian Languages so that they become the vehicles of European scientific, historical and literary expression.
Macaulay wanted the government to spend money only on imparting western education and not on oriental education. He advocated the shutting down of all colleges where only eastern philosophy and subjects were taught.
Woods Dispatch of 1854 suggested that primary schools must adopt vernacular languages, high schools must adopt Anglo-vernacular language and at college-level English should be the medium of education.

21. Among the four political parties listed below, which one was the last to be formed?
(a) The Conservative Party in Britain
(b) The Democratic Party in U.S.A.
(c) The Republican Party in U.S.A.
(d) The Indian National Congress

Ans. (d) : The Conservative Party in Britain was established in 1834.
The Democratic Party in U.S.A was established in 1828.
The Republican Party in U.S.A was established in 1854.
The Indian National Congress was established in 1885.
Thus it is very clear that the Indian National Congress Party was established at the last.

22. The first political organization established in India in 1838 was known as:
(a) British India Society
(b) Bengal British India Society
(c) Settlers Association
(d) Zamindari Association

Ans. (d) : The Zamindari Association, which was later renamed Landholders' Society, was established on 12th November 1837 by Dwarkanath Tagore, Prasanna Kumar Tagore, Radhakanta Deb, Ramkamal Sen and Bhabani Charan Mitra.
It has been described as "the first organisation of Bengal with distinct political object."

23. Which of the following were the main objectives of the Khilafat movement?
I. To rouse anti-British feelings among the Muslims of India.
II. To reform the Muslim society.
III. To demand separate electorates and preserve the Khilafat.
IV. To save the Ottoman Empire and preserve the Khilafat.
Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:
Codes:
(a) I and II (b) II and III
(c) III and IV (d) I and IV

Ans. (d) : The Khilafat movement (1919-1924) was an agitation by Indian Muslims allied with Indian nationalism in the years following World War I. Its purpose was to pressure the British government to preserve the authority of the Ottoman Sultan as Caliph of Islam following the breakup of the Ottoman Empire at the end of the war. Gandhiji saw an opportunity for a Hindu-Muslim mass movement and hence joined his non-cooperation with the khilafat issue. It was started in the year 1919. The non-cooperation movement started to spread in different parts of the country. In September 1921, the Ali brothers (Muhammad Ali and Shaukat Ali) were arrested who had started the movement.
Moreover, Gandhiji suspended the Non-Cooperation Movement after the ChauriChaura incident in 1922.

24. "Indian cotton merchant, banker, Congressman and a close associate of Mahatma Gandhi". This description fits:
(a) G.D. Birla (b) M.R. Jayakar
(c) Jamanalal Bajaj (d) V.S. Srinivasa Sastri

Ans. (c) : Jamnalal Bajaj was famous cotton merchant, banker ,Congressman and a close associate of Mahatma Gandhi. Jamanalal Bajaj was interested in initiatives such as the removal of untouchability, promotion of Hindi, and Khadi and village Industries. With the intent of eradicating untouchability, he fought for the non-admission of Harijans into Hindu temples in his home town of Wardha. He began a campaign by eating a meal with Harijans and opening public wells to them. He opened several wells in his fields and gardens.
In honour of his social initiatives the Jamanalal Bajaj Award has been instituted by the Bajaj Foundation.

25. The title given by British Government to Mahatma Gandhi which, he surrendered during the Non-cooperation Movement, was:
(a) Hind Kesari (b) Kaisar-e-Hind
(c) Rai Bahadur (d) Rt. Honourable

Ans. (b) : Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, who was awarded the Kaiser-i-Hind in 1915 by The Lord Hardinge of Penshurst for his contribution to ambulance services in South Africa during the time of First World War.